

Cole Fisher

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EDUCATION

Western University (UWO), London, Ontario, Canada

2013 - 2017

- Hon. BSc – Honors Specialization in Computer Science with distinction
- Programming experience: Python, Java, R, JavaScript, jQuery, SQL
- Computer Science average: 88%
- Dean's Honor List (2013, 2014, 2015, 2016, 2017)

WORK EXPERIENCE & PROJECTS

Minnesota Timberwolves

October 2024 - Present

Manager of Basketball Analytics

- Led a department of engineers, data scientists and analysts, all tasked with the same end goal of helping the Timberwolves decision makers gain access to timely and accurate data.
- Developed a culture that valued collaboration, hard work, discipline, thoughtfulness and proud ownership over the code and the analysis.
- Tasked with setting priorities and expectations for all members of the analytics department.

Minnesota Timberwolves

October 2018 - 2024

Basketball Operations & Coaching Analyst

- Contributed to all facets of the analytics department, including, but not limited to, database pipeline processes, automated reporting, interactive tools for the coaching staff and front office, and ad-hoc analysis.
- Traveled with the team and sat behind the bench, thereby able to provide the coaching staff and players with data driven insights to improve their performance.
- Worked closely with all members of the organization, including the front office, coaching staff, performance staff and the players.
- Helped to unite the department and allow it to scale eventually by imposing proper git workflow, modular code, and the creation of an all-in-one central web-app.

Sacramento Kings

Spring 2018

Basketball Analytics Intern

- Assisted in the planning and execution of the Kings' analytics large-scale database.
- Wrote web-scraping scripts to gather and clean large datasets necessary for data analysis.
- Took a lead role in the development of the Kings' proprietary 2018 Draft web app that the front-office consulted throughout the entire draft process.
- Used in-house four-year total wins added projections to forecast each NBA team's long-term depth chart.
 - These depth charts allowed the front-office to make personnel decisions and trade offers based on positional strength/weakness.

Toronto Raptors

Summer 2017

Basketball Operations Intern

- Led the logistical planning and execution of all 2017 draft workouts and the 3-day free agent mini-camp.
- Completed several tasks for the Basketball Operations staff, including:
 - Programs that scrape NCAA game data and NBA game data daily
 - A database that aggregates a player's many IDs (ESPN, NBA.com, basketball-reference, sports-reference) in one place to ensure proper data is being scraped/queried.
 - A G League stats database to facilitate analytical decision making regarding G League prospects.
- Worked closely with the analytics staff to create a linear regression model that predicts NBA 3FG% based on NCAA statistics. The final paper can be provided upon request.

G League to NBA Player Predictor

December 2017 – September 2018

- Created a web application to help users accurately predict future NBA success for current G League players.
- Developed alongside Cole's Regress, Cluster, Classify (RCC) methodology, a machine learning approach to domain → domain predictions.
- Uses python's scikit-learn library to perform regression, clustering, classification and k-nearest neighbors.
- Classifies a G League player as a certain G League role and provides three NBA player comparisons who have similar stats to the G League prospect's projected NBA output.

CoinRoster.com

2018

Lead Full-Stack Developer

- CoinRoster is a daily fantasy sports website based out of Toronto that uses Bitcoin as its currency.
- Led a team of 3 developers by divvying up tasks and outlining a plan for hitting all deadlines.
- Point-person for communication between the non-technical shareholders and the team of developers
- Responsible for automating the creating/live-scoring/settling processes for all fantasy sports contests.
 - Saved the shareholders 2+ hours daily by migrating from manual contest creation/settlement processes to automated ones.